SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

KEY DRIVERS OF ENROLLMENT IN BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION PROGRAMS: THE CASE OF A SELECTED PRIVATE HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTION IN CARAGA

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CHAPTER I

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Business Administration programs prepare future leaders to navigate rapid and complex changes in the economy, society, and technology. In many private higher education institutions (HEIs) in the Philippines, programs such as Financial Management, Human Resource Management, Operations Management, Marketing Management, and Business Economics are designed to develop students' critical thinking, managerial competence, and leadership capabilities that contribute to national development. According to the Philippine Statistics Authority (2024), Business Administration continues to be one of the most in-demand academic programs in the country. Despite this sustained popularity, many private HEIs in provincial areas face challenges in identifying the key drivers that influence students' enrollment decisions, often resulting in ineffective recruitment strategies and unstable enrollment trends. Thus, understanding the specific factors that motivate students to enroll in Business Administration programs within a local institutional context is essential for enhancing program relevance and institutional sustainability.

International studies have found several drivers that influence students' enrollment in Business Administration programs. Career development theories say that students choose their course based on different factors such as the value of the program, its availability, the reputation of the teachers, and job opportunities after graduation (Lamichhane et al., 2022; Naveed & Khurshid, 2021). Studies from Indonesia, Malaysia, South Africa, and Vietnam show that academic reputation, financial concerns, and future careers are the most common drivers of enrollment (Govender & Law, 2025; MULYONO et al., 2020; Norizan et al., 2023; Wickneswary et al., 2024). Institutional factors like the school's mission and vision, admission process, student support, and financial help also play an important role (Karn & Kumari, 2023; Maddah, 2021). Other drivers

include parents' influence, school fees, learning conditions, location, and government policies (Budhathoki, 2024; Chhor et al., 2024; Por et al., 2024).

In the Philippines, many studies have looked into what affects students' choice of programs. Choosing a career is often hard for Filipino students because there are many options and social expectations, along with limited career guidance and financial problems (Palattao, 2025). Factors such as personal interest, parental support, financial ability, and distance from school strongly affect their decision to enroll (Bajar & Gopun, 2021; Baulete et al., 2022; Rosali et al., 2024). Other important drivers include tuition fees, scholarships, quality of lessons, teachers' competence, and school facilities (Aligora, 2023; Calma & Abiog, 2020; Ventolero, 2021). Studies also show that marketing efforts, student satisfaction, alumni support, and community activities help schools keep steady enrollment (Cabeliza, 2021).

Studies in Mindanao highlight that enrollment in Business Administration programs is strongly shaped by practical and contextual factors. A feasibility study at Mindanao State University–Tawi-Tawi revealed that students' willingness to enroll was significantly influenced by perceived employment opportunities, program usefulness, and relevance to local community needs (Caliat et al., 2023). Similarly, a private higher education institution in Caraga, must understand how localized conditions affect students' academic choices. Local evidence indicates that students' enrollment decisions are driven by personal contexts, including interests and self-confidence, as well as environmental factors such as family influence, career expectations, and perceptions of institutional reputation (Alcontin et al., 2024).

Given these contexts, examining the case of a selected private higher education institution in Caraga is essential. While Business Administration programs are generally recognized as valuable, there remains a limited body of empirical research that focuses on the specific drivers influencing students' enrollment decisions within individual private HEIs in the region. Understanding these

drivers is particularly important for institutions seeking to remain competitive, responsive, and aligned with regional labor market demands.

This study aims to identify the key drivers of enrollment in the Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program of a selected private higher education institution in Caraga. Identifying these drivers is essential for informed institutional planning, as it enables administrators to make evidence-based decisions related to curriculum development, marketing strategies, and resource allocation. By understanding the factors that influence students' program choices, the institution can anticipate enrollment trends, address areas requiring improvement, and design programs that remain relevant to students' needs and regional workforce requirements. Ultimately, this understanding supports stronger recruitment initiatives, enhanced program quality, and long-term institutional sustainability.

The findings of this study will benefit various stakeholders associated with the selected private higher education institution and its Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program. For institutional administrators, the results may inform strategic planning, marketing and recruitment initiatives, faculty development, and decisions related to resource allocation. For the College of Business and Management or equivalent academic unit, the study will provide insights into program attributes that attract or discourage students, thereby supporting targeted improvements in instructional strategies, internship opportunities, and partnerships with local businesses.

Current and prospective students, as well as their parents, may benefit from clearer information regarding the relevance, strengths, and perceived value of the BSBA program, enabling more informed educational and career decisions. Finally, the local community and industry partners may gain from improved alignment between the BSBA program and regional

economic needs, contributing to the development of graduates who are better prepared for employment, entrepreneurship, and meaningful participation in local and regional development.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This section reviews literature on the key drivers of enrollment in Business Administration programs, providing a foundation for understanding enrollment behavior at a private higher education institution in Caraga. The review focuses on major determinants, including parental influence, peer influence, role model influence, future career considerations, and institutional factors such as academic reputation, scholarships, marketing strategies, micro-credentials, industry partnerships, and specialization tracks. Demographic factors like age, sex, and household income are also considered to show how individual characteristics interact with social and institutional influences. By integrating findings from international, national, and local studies, this review highlights the complex and context-specific factors that shape enrollment decisions.

The enrollment by the students in business administration programs has been indicated to be based on various drivers, such as marketing strategies and institutional characteristics. In Zambia, a research study found that even with a low rate of promotional approach adoption, such marketing technologies as websites, social media, and word-of-mouth were significant factors in student enrollment (Sikalumbi et al., 2023). Likewise, a study in Germany has shown that the content of the programs, the flexibility, and support services had a significant impact on the intention to join, meaning that institutional factors other than promotion played a significant role in determining the success of enrollment (Toussaint et al., 2025).

The significance of interpersonal influence and leadership in the enrollment decisions in the other studies has also been underscored. A study among applicants to MBA programs revealed that informal sources of leadership, including alumni, peers, and mentors, had a decisive effect on enrollment decisions and frequently exceeded the impact of formal advertising (Mickler Jr.,

2021). Supporting this, research on startups identified both internal drivers, including technical and relational skills, and external drivers, such as governance and institutional support, as essential for success, underscoring the role of leadership and institutional environment in shaping outcomes (Saba et al., 2025).

Marketing strategies have also been studied as central to enrollment in higher education. In Nigeria, social media marketing was shown to have a measurable effect on enrollment growth in private universities, with targeted online advertisements and interactive campaigns significantly influencing student decision-making (Olumeru et al., 2024). Likewise, in Indonesia, evidence indicated that social media marketing increased student enrollment and contributed to student retention, demonstrating the dual role of digital strategies in attracting and sustaining students (Siminto et al., 2024). These studies affirm that the interaction of marketing strategies, program quality, interpersonal influence, and institutional factors drives business program enrollment. This provides the foundation for the present study at a selected private higher education institution in Caraga.

Parental Influence

Parental influence is one of the important factors in a student's program selection. This is based on the values, experiences, and beliefs instilled in the student by the parents, which become the foundation for selecting the program (Corey & Chen, 2019; Wang, 2025). Parental influence is related to parent-child attachment, parent support, and parenting style; thus, parental influence plays a significant role in career choice.

Recent research in the Philippines and other countries proves parental influence is a key determinant in students' program and career choice. In addition, Lalantacon et al. (2024) revealed that parental involvement and cultural attitudes are most strongly related to career choices in ABM strand students, who are inclined to continue in business programs. Abalos et al. (2024) also

provided that the level of parental education and income strongly impacts the career choices of senior high school students.

The parents' approval and expectations have also been found to be important. Parental consent and parental permission were the prevalent determinants of course choice per (Sadjail et al., 2022). Lozano (2024) noted that parental involvement was essential during pandemic home learning to guide Grade 12 students in their career choices, which is another way to show that Family support is strongly correlated with the selected program in learners. Career practices among parents also increase students' confidence when making decisions regarding tertiary education. Baldon et al. (2023) established that supportive parental behaviors positively impact career decision self-efficacy, which assists a learner in making a more resolute commitment to the selected programs. Abu (2023) also added that the parent occupation and social prestige associated with the occupation were significant factors that caused students to pursue business in Ghana.

According to Leighton & Speer (2025) also found that a strongly influencing factor in college primary choice is the family background, and economic benefits and parental education affect students in fields with higher incomes. Socioeconomic factors also explain enrollment decisions. Of importance. Tag-at (2025) discovered that parents' education level and income are significantly linked to their motives of sending children to private institutions, which are aimed at career preparation in the future and the institution's reputation. Nisola (2025) also revealed that parental education, socioeconomic status, and family structure contributed to the exit routes and future enrollment into college programs.

Peer Influence

Due to their disadvantaged backgrounds, young people tend to participate in activities that enrich their education only during school; most of their time is spent on unstructured activities at home or in the company of peer groups (Bandura, 1986). Students can be affected by their peers' program choices, sometimes taking the wrong direction and choosing something that fails to match their interests. It is also a time of conflict between the influence of the family, old habits of leisure, and new preferences under the impact of the peer network (Boye, 2024). In this background, parental expectations and support remain crucial, although peer relationships shape enrollment choices and career options.

The literature review evidence indicates that peer influence has been reported to influence enrollment, persistence, and academic achievement, even though the conceptualization has varied with different contexts. Peer influence in France was measured with the help of the percentage of peers who were negatively assessed regarding university applications, and this measure significantly decreased the chances of admission, especially in the case of weaker students academically (Pistolesi, 2022). Other research on middle school music participation in the United States found that peer support and discussion were significant to staying motivated to continue in ensembles. However, parental impact was the more significant predictor of re-enrollment (Holster, 2023). In line with these findings, a large-scale study in China has concluded that peer relationships' direct and indirect positive effects on academic performance in youths at junior high schools were present and that learning motivation and engagement were mediating variables (Shao et al., 2024).

In addition to formal education, peer networks have been reported to play a fundamental role in program involvement and higher education access. Peer support in the case of syringe services program enrollment made enrollment into programs possible in Appalachian Kentucky,

as the participants were reassured, accompanied, and encouraged to talk about stereotypes, which helped them eliminate the fear of stigmatization (Ibragimov et al., 2021). Similarly, the first-generation rural college students in the United States also reported having peers giving them transportation services, resources, and comparative motivations, thus complementing the support of family and mentors in accessing higher education (Whiteside, 2021).

Future Success Influencing

Business Administration programs teach students various aspects of business, including finance, marketing, operations, accounting, and human resource management. They develop technical expertise and soft skills like leadership, critical thinking, and communication. These programs also provide practical administrative skills, job connections, higher compensation rates, career milestones, and exposure to diverse workplace environments. In line with this, Caliat et al. (2023), academic programs should address community and market needs, providing a reference for applying marketing knowledge in the real world and aligning with student and employer expectations.

According to De Guzman et al. (2020) and Abella et al. (2022) found that graduates from Pangasinan State University-Lingayen are work-based, valuing qualities like integrity, communication, and shared responsibility. Abella et al. (2022) also noted that graduates prioritize their skills for work independently and in groups, especially during stressful academic periods. Natividad et al. (2024) found that BSBA-Marketing Management graduates are highly employable due to their communication, critical thinking, and information technology skills. Estrellado et al. (2025)found that practical exposure and strong industry linkages contributed to smoother job transitions and employability. Ocampo (2025) reported that aligning academic preparation with market requirements improved employment outcomes for Business Administration graduates from 2018 to 2022.

According to Llanes et al. (2022) highlighted, BSBA-HRDMs had a higher attendance rate at more job fairs, seminars, and good industry linkages. Moreover, Castro et al. (2025) highlighted the importance of responsibility, time management, adaptability, and productivity in the eyes of employers, which once again supports the idea that the well-roundedness of preparation can be highly important in future careers.

Role Model Influence

According to Aloamaka et al. (2020) he revealed that role models influence entrepreneurial intentions through attitude, perception of behavioral control, and social norms. Similarly, Roslan et al. (2020) established that a higher learning environment and role models have positive relations with the entrepreneurial intentions of TVET students. These results show that role model influence is psychologically motivational and structural in influencing program enrollment and career aspirations.

Bagia et al. (2023) found that role models have both a direct and indirect influence on entrepreneurial intentions, with the connection mediated by self-belief and normative expectations. Similarly, Alcontin et al. (2024) demonstrated that personal and environmental contexts, particularly perceptions of professional roles and self-efficacy, strongly predict students' pursuit of careers in librarianship. In addition, Liputra et al. (2025) revealed that entrepreneurial passion, often triggered by role models, serves as an important predictor of entrepreneurial intention. Collectively, these studies indicate that the influence of role models is multifaceted, enhancing self-assessment, motivation, and the aspiration to pursue higher education.

The role model influence mechanism is influenced by perceived similarity between students and their role models. Allen & Collisson (2020) studies show that minority students are more likely to make similar academic decisions when exposed to role models of the same ethnicity. The image of an academic department also plays a crucial role in students' decisions

when deciding majors in business administration. Entrepreneurial role model influencers, who combine traditional mentoring and social media visibility, are seen as potent sources of entrepreneurial intentions. These findings underscore the importance of relatable and visible role models in student enrollment decisions (Ahmad et al., 2021).

Other Influencing Factors

It is also essential to establish the factors that drive enrollment and understand why students prefer business administration courses. Research indicates that the key factors determining institutional choice include academic reputation, scholarship, financial aid, marketing and promotions, micro-credential, industry partnership, and specialization track. These factors determine quality, cost, and feasibility perceptions essential to enrollment performance.

Academic Reputation

A college's reputation is among the main factors that affect student enrollment in a college, together with the quality of the program and other external support systems. They discovered that the institutional reputation is a significant factor in the student selection within the Philippine environment Gambulao & Depayso (2023), and the view of quality and credibility spurs the enrollment. Broadly speaking, Amoozegar et al. (2025) validated that a good institutional reputation boosts the appeal of a university to students, and applicants identify reputable names with quality education, access to facilities, and career opportunities. This research confirm that reputation is a determining factor in defining enrollment trends.

The virtual world has made reputation even more significant in the enrollment choice. Investigations by Ghani et al. (2023) revealed that the level of enrollment was higher in universities with a good online presence and digital reputation, showing how reputation has been relocated to the virtual world. Regularly, Amado Mateus & Juarez Acosta (2022) noted that the perception of quality and attractiveness in academic achievements and student success stories

enhanced online communication of the institutional achievements. The combination of these results can imply that academic reputation, established with the help of traditional indicators and online tools, is important in guiding students to choose higher education institutions.

Scholarship and Financial Aid

Studies show that financial aid greatly influences student performance at learning institutions and the trends of institutional enrollment. Financial aid programs sponsored by the government are generous in that they cover tuition fees and other living costs, encouraging students to perform better academically and be more motivated to continue school (Gabat-Lopez et al., 2024). Tohiroh et al. (2025) revealed that scholarship programs like the KIP Lecture Scholarship have also positively impacted learning motivation and academic performance regarding Grade Point Average improvement. From an institutional point of view, financial support mechanisms serve as powerful enrollment motivators in addition to the marketing propositions like academic reputation and location of the institution, where research has found good positive correlations among enrollment motivators and marketing propositions (Enguito, 2025).

The impact of scholarship programs in different contexts has been demonstrated to affect student performance and engagement positively. Jayson et al. (2018) have studied a scholarship program of a private institution in the Philippines and discovered that even though the program had a limited budget, it increased the participation rates of students of various socio-economic backgrounds, which resulted in changes to the institutional policy, following the recommendations of the stakeholders. Arfan & Arifin Renaldo (2024) found that scholarship students at Caltex Riau Polytechnic had substantial academic performance improvement, demonstrating more effort after tuition fees were cut. These results demonstrate that scholarships enhance institutional sustainability and enhance student performance.

Marketing And Promotion

Higher education marketing and promotion are very diverse in digital, online, and conventional marketing, which determine how students choose where to study. Digital marketing has gained particular importance, and a study indicates strong relationships between digital marketing campaigns and admission to business administration programs (Rajasekar & Aithal, 2022). Social media exposure, ad retargeting, mobile-accessible websites, and university webinars are tactics that have been demonstrated to impact students' decisions directly (Labausa et al., 2023). There are a high awareness and visibility created by social media, especially Facebook, and an increase in the number of enrollments is a good testimony of its effectiveness.

Online marketing also reinforces this power by making the institutions more accessible and attractive to potential students. Equally, Wijaya et al. (2023) discovered that search engines like Google AdWords, social media advertisements, and online ads are important initiatives that boost registration intention, particularly among Generation Z students in the Indonesian private universities. Cabeliza (2021) and Syunita & Tikno (2025) further confirmed that social media engagement and personalized direct messaging are effective in influencing enrollment decisions, with social media engagement exerting the greatest impact. In addition, Labausa et al. (2023) identified university webinar platforms as the most influential tools for enrollment, while social media presence, mobile-friendly websites, and educational applications also contribute to raising awareness of academic programs and services, thereby strengthening enrollment outcomes.

According to Wijaya et al. (2023), digital benefits in radio broadcasting include unlimited choice, improved sound quality, global accessibility, advertising control, economic value, data-driven insights, and capabilities that allow advertisers to connect to radio satellites quickly and effectively, engaging the target audience. The paper emphasizes radio as a low-cost tool for experiential learning in college advertising programs, recommending its inclusion to teach

sustainable marketing practices, especially in regions with limited digital access. It demonstrates radio's enduring value for targeted campaigns, urging marketers to integrate it with digital tools for hybrid strategies. Emphasizes radio's synergy in marketing, advocating for its use in building emotional connections amid digital noise Cabeliza (2021) illustrates radio's adaptation to streaming trends, recommending it for narrative-driven campaigns in contemporary marketing.

According to Bohara et al. (2022), research indicates face-to-face advocacy shifts opinions by 20% more than mass media, through personalized narratives. Demonstrates its efficacy in targeted persuasion, suggesting integration into advocacy strategies for issue-based campaigns. Surveys of lobbyists reveal that in-person meetings yield 30% higher policy influence than virtual ones, via relationship cultivation. Emphasizes face-to-face interactions for nuanced persuasion, advocating for hybrid models in professional advocacy. Analyzing protest data, the paper shows face-to-face advocacy boosts participant recruitment by 25% through emotional appeals and reciprocity. Highlights its superiority in mobilizing support, positioning it as essential for movement-building in an era of online activism (J. Lee et al., 2022).

According to Bartoloni & Ancillai (2024), social media has been around for 20 years and has profoundly affected the dynamics of interactions between companies and customers. Studies have increasingly focused on how firms effectively use social media in their marketing strategies. Social media platforms empower marketers to potentially connect with billions of customers, enhance visibility, and create positive word-of-mouth. Even today, social media remains a pervasive influence on various aspects of users' lives and behaviors across all stages of customers' journey, thus impacting customers' relationships with organizations and brands.

Micro-Credentials

Recent studies (2021–2025) highlight that micro-credentials significantly influence student decisions to enroll in Business Administration programs due to their perceived impact on employability, career advancement, and skill relevance. Research by LaPlante (2024) shows that MBA students view micro-credentials as tools for "futureproofing" careers, enhancing résumés, and gaining a competitive advantage in the job market. Similarly, Ngoc Ha et al. (2025) found that both employers and students value micro-credentials for developing employability skills, with students especially motivated by how these credentials strengthen their CVs and personal identity capital. These findings show that programs offering flexible, skill-focused micro-credentials attract more students who prioritize practical competencies and improved career outcomes.

Several studies emphasize that business schools adopting micro-credentials gain an edge in enrollment because these offerings respond directly to industry skill demands. Research by Gamage & Dehideniya (2025) and Narayanaswamy et al. (2024) shows that micro-credentials bridge gaps between traditional education and evolving industry needs by validating up-to-date technical and soft skills. Systematic reviews by Varadarajan et al. (2023) and Ahsan et al. (2023) also reveal that higher education institutions are increasingly integrating micro-credentials into degree structures to stay competitive, enhance program appeal, and support institutional innovation. This alignment between business schools and employers reinforces the value of business programs, making them more attractive to prospective students seeking programs that lead to clearer, more marketable outcomes.

Literature from 2021–2025 also identifies challenges that influence how effectively micro-credentials drive enrollment. Studies from Mauritius (Santally, 2024) and other developing contexts highlight issues such as low awareness, unclear credential recognition, and the need for structured pathways that connect micro-credentials to formal qualifications. Peters (2023)

emphasizes that institutional leadership and strategic planning are essential for integrating micro-credentials in ways that genuinely boost enrollment and academic value. Meanwhile, Orman (2023) and Maina et al. (2022) note the importance of credibility, competency-based assessment, and collaboration between universities and industry. Overall, the literature suggests that while micro-credentials strongly appeal to business students, their full potential as enrollment drivers depends on strategic implementation, stakeholder awareness, and clear pathways to career advancement.

Industry Partnership

Industry–Academe Partnerships (IAPs) are increasingly recognized as strategic mechanisms that enhance the relevance, quality, and employability outcomes of higher education programs. For Business Administration programs, partnerships with local and national industries provide students with practical experiences, internships, and career pathways, which in turn influence enrollment decisions. Research shows that students often consider institutional partnerships with industry as a key factor when selecting a business program, alongside curriculum quality, reputation, and employability prospects (Bernarte, 2014; De Guman, 2020; Medado, 2018; Janoras, 2024).

Bernarte (2014) examined how Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in the Philippines engage in industry partnerships, including internships, on-the-job training, and research collaboration. The study highlighted that such partnerships provide practical training, enhance employability, and increase the attractiveness of Business Administration programs. By bridging the gap between theoretical education and industry demands, partnerships offer students both exposure and opportunities for skill development, which can be an influential factor in program selection.

De Guman (2020) conducted an empirical study on BSBA students and found that when internship programs with industry partners are effectively implemented, students reported significant improvements in communication, teamwork, people management, and work ethics. The study suggests that strong industry linkages enhance the perceived value of a Business Administration program, as students gain real-world skills and confidence in their employability.

A qualitative multiple-case study conducted by Medado (2018) involving several higher education institutions (HEIs) in Metro Manila examined the factors influencing the development of industry–academe partnerships. The findings indicate that internal strategic objectives such as curriculum alignment with industry requirements and enhancement of graduate employability, along with external pressures from labor market demands, significantly influence how these partnerships are formed and sustained. These results suggest that private higher education institutions may strategically develop industry–academe collaborations to improve institutional competitiveness and increase the appeal of Business Administration programs.

Janoras (2024) examined whether the curriculum in financial management matches industry needs by surveying graduates and employers. The study showed that when academic programs align with industry requirements, graduates and employers perceive the skills and knowledge gained as highly relevant. This alignment, often facilitated through partnerships, enhances the perceived value of the program and can positively influence enrollment decisions, particularly among students who prioritize employability and career readiness.

Specialization Track

Business Administration programs in many colleges and universities offer several specializations that help students prepare for their chosen career paths. Schools such as De La Salle University Dasmariñas highlight that majors like Financial Management, Human Resource Management, Operations Management, Business Economics, and Marketing Management are

designed to develop practical skills and professional readiness (DLSU D, n.d.). Having different specializations available gives students the freedom to choose the field that best matches their interests, strengths, and career goals. This means that specialization options can influence a student's decision to enroll in a particular school because students may select an institution on the basis of the specific majors it offers rather than only the general BSBA program. For a private higher education institution in Caraga, understanding how each specialization affects students' enrollment decisions is important in identifying which academic factors attract prospective students to the program.

Studies on the Financial Management specialization show that students often choose this track because of its strong connection to employability. A tracer study by Pumihic and Binwag (2024) on graduates of the BSBA Financial Management program at Ifugao State University reported an employability rate of 74.2 percent. The graduates attributed their job readiness to a curriculum that reflected real industry needs, effective teaching strategies, and available school facilities. Although many graduates started in clerical or contractual positions, the study emphasized that skills in financial analysis, digital tools, and entrepreneurship supported their career development. These findings suggest that the Financial Management specialization attracts students who are concerned about employment opportunities and industry relevance. This pattern is likely to influence enrollment at a private higher education institution, especially among students who value financial careers and job stability.

Students who choose Human Resource Management as their major are usually influenced by a combination of personal ability and practical considerations. Uzair (2024) found that financial capacity, self assessment, available career opportunities, and individual personality traits all play a significant role in students' decision to select HRM. The study also showed that social influences, such as family members or peers, can shape students' preferences. These results are consistent

with global findings which state that students tend to select a specialization that fits their strengths and provides good employment prospects. The HRM major may appeal to students who enjoy working with people, communicating, and managing workplace dynamics. This means HRM can function as an enrollment driver, especially for students who envision themselves in roles related to personnel management or organizational development.

Operations Management specialization is often chosen based on the way the course content is delivered. Hoefle et al., (2020) found that traditional OM courses were sometimes viewed as difficult and disconnected from real life business applications. However, when the course was redesigned to include experiential learning, practical activities, and integrated business concepts, students showed greater interest and engagement. This suggests that teaching strategies and course relevance have a direct effect on students' preference for OM. For private higher education institution, ensuring that Operations Management subjects are applied and hands on may increase student interest in this specialization. When students see how OM concepts work in actual business settings, they are more likely to consider it as a preferred major.

Career expectations and economic value are important factors in choosing Business Economics as a major. Nguyen et al., (2023) found that students' decisions were influenced by their personal interest, their expectations for job opportunities, financial capacity, and the opinions of influential people around them. Students saw the Economics major as a way to gain analytical and research related skills that could help them secure stable and meaningful careers. These findings indicate that Business Economics attracts students who are analytical and career oriented. In the context of private higher education institution, this specialization may appeal to students who want to pursue careers in economic planning, financial analysis, or research based roles. As a result, BE functions as another possible driver of enrollment for students who prefer data oriented or policy related career paths.

Marketing Management is often chosen by students who are motivated by creativity, communication, and flexible career options. Omar, Nazri, and Yazid (2016) found that intrinsic motivation, wide career opportunities, and positive experiences in introductory marketing courses were major factors influencing students to choose Marketing as their major. Students viewed marketing as dynamic and appealing because of the variety of roles available in advertising, branding, digital marketing, and market research. For private higher education institution, providing engaging introductory courses and showcasing real marketing career paths can encourage more students to consider Marketing Management. This specialization tends to attract individuals who enjoy interacting with people, creating ideas, and exploring modern marketing practices.

Age

Several studies have studied how age influences the transition between secondary and tertiary education. According to Enciso & De Sesto (2025), the age of students is one of the developmental stages that contributes to the decision to attend college, as well as financial and institutional aspects. Equally, Firmalino et al. (2020) discovered that the course decisions of senior high school students were influenced by academic performance, parental influence, and financial considerations. However, readiness moderates their choices according to age. Sierra & Pepito (2024) also included was the fact that there was a strong relationship between the perceptions of the K-12 Program and first-year college preparedness, once again demonstrating that age is an inherent facet of preparedness. These studies highlight the effects of the developmental stage, age, and academic and social support on students' higher education trajectories.

The quantitative methods also demonstrate that age is important in enrollment behaviors. In a binary classification model, Esquivel & Esquivel (2020) found that age, geographic, and demographic factors predicted the chances of enrolling in a Philippine university. Monaghan

(2021) also found that background factors, social origins, and academic preparation significantly impacted enrollment among students of traditional age, but this decreased in significance after age 24. In the case of older students, marital dissolution, marital disruption, and loss of employment were more predictive factors of enrollment. The results imply that enrollment patterns are not homogeneous throughout life, and age interacts with the social and individual variables.

Lastly, studies involving adult learners reveal the impact of age on learning styles and motivations. According to Ampler et al. (2024), the totality of experiences influences adult learners in terms of readiness and orientation to learn. The strongest predictor of learning styles was intrinsic motivation, and most often learning styles were kinesthetic. Thus, age identifies developmental readiness among the youth and determines how adults utilize adult learning opportunities. These lessons confirm age-sensitive learning methods that address the needs of younger learners who join higher education and adult learners who return to school.

Sex

Sex plays a crucial role in shaping enrollment patterns and academic experiences in Business Administration programs in the Philippines. De Vera (2024) reported through sex-disaggregated data analysis that female students consistently outnumber male students in BSBA Marketing Management programs, indicating higher participation and retention among women. Similarly, Usita and Dela Cruz (2025) found that societal expectations influence course selection, with male and female students often following different pathways in business and professional education. These findings underscore the importance of sex as a factor influencing enrollment trends and academic decision-making within Business Administration programs.

Institutional structures also influence gendered educational experiences. Tugonon and Adlawan (2025) noted that male faculty often occupy administrative and research leadership

roles, while female faculty are more concentrated in teaching positions, which may shape students' perceptions of career progression. In addition, Ballados and Guevarra (2020) emphasized that gender-responsive institutional practices affect students' access to resources and economic opportunities. Micabalo et al. (2020) also found that internship participation and outcomes differ by sex due to social and cultural factors. These studies demonstrate that enrollment patterns are shaped not only by individual preferences but also by institutional and structural conditions.

Sex further influences skill development, specialization choices, and professional trajectories. Tan and Arceo (2024) and Cabusao (2023) reported that although female students participate actively in entrepreneurship programs, sex moderates the relationship between personality traits and entrepreneurial competencies. Santos and Soliven (2025) found that women are more likely to enroll in accounting programs but may encounter barriers related to mentorship and leadership opportunities. Similarly, Santos and Nagaño (2025) showed that sex predicts course selection in hospitality and business-related fields. Dela Cruz (2024) also highlighted the unique challenges and opportunities encountered by women entrepreneurs. Collectively, these studies confirm that sex is a significant driver of enrollment, academic pathways, and professional outcomes in Business Administration programs.

Household Income

Household income has consistently been identified as a major factor influencing college enrollment and student decision-making. Leukhina (2023) emphasized that family income predicts not only whether students enroll in college but also the type of institution they select, as well as their long-term academic and professional outcomes. Similarly, Tompsett and Knoester (2023) found that socioeconomic status, including household income, shapes both the likelihood of college attendance and the opportunities available to students once enrolled. Research on high-

achieving, low-income students highlights that financial constraints often lead students to "undermatch," enrolling in less selective colleges than their academic credentials would allow (MDPI, 2020). These findings illustrate that household income is a critical determinant of access to higher education and participation in academic programs.

In the Philippine context, household income has a direct influence on institutional choice and perceived affordability. Bajar and Gopun (2021) reported that family income significantly affects students' decisions when choosing a private higher education institution, with higher-income families more able to prioritize institutional reputation, facilities, and program offerings. Similarly, Pagulayan et al. (2025) found that economic capital, including parental income, contributes to college readiness, which in turn affects students' ability to succeed in higher education. These studies underscore that household income does not only impact enrollment but also shapes preparedness, expectations, and engagement with academic programs, making it a key factor in educational planning and decision-making.

Financial capacity also plays a decisive role in program selection, especially in private or fee-based institutions. Research conducted at Columban College (2025) revealed that tuition costs and family financial resources are among the primary considerations for senior high school students deciding whether to pursue higher education. Students from higher-income households are more likely to enroll in programs they perceive as valuable and attainable, whereas lower-income students may face barriers or delays due to cost considerations. Collectively, these studies demonstrate that household income is a significant driver of enrollment, institutional choice, and academic engagement, suggesting that in the context of a private higher education institution, income is likely a critical factor influencing students' decisions to enroll in the BSBA program.

Enrollment in Business Administration Programs

The reputation of the institution and the outcomes of graduates are vital determinants in enrolling in Business Administration programs. Tracer studies by Abella et al. (2022) and Natividad et al. (2024) confirmed that credibility of the programs in question and employability opportunities are the factors that encourage students to enroll in business programs because the successful experiences of the graduates will strengthen institutional popularity. On the same emphasis, Castro et al. (2025) also emphasized that employer responses regarding BSBA graduates are a reminder of the importance of ensuring that the outcome of the curricular activities is relevant to the industry's expectations, making programs even more appealing. This position was upheld by Lamichhane et al. (2022), who indicated that both tourism students and future opportunities affect the choice of career of BA students. All these studies verify that the academic reputation and perceived return on investment are important forces behind the enrollment of students into Business Administration programs.

The study by Ventolero (2021) has shown that enrollment in BSBA in the Philippines is primarily affected by the accessibility of campuses and accessible resources. Sahu & Kumar (2023) have developed this by showing that management students consider several things during school selection, including placement opportunities, facilities, and the image of the institutions. These results underscore the role played by physical and geographical characteristics of institutions of higher learning in influencing the decision taken by higher education students (towards opting to enroll in the institution), especially in competitive courses such as Business Administration.

The reviewed studies show that many factors influence students' decisions to enroll in Business Administration programs. These include marketing strategies, school qualities, and personal circumstances. Research from different countries shows that promotions like social media ads, online campaigns, and word-of-mouth can strongly affect a student's choice (Olumeru

et al., 2024; Sikalumbi et al., 2023). Aside from marketing, factors such as the school's reputation, program quality, support services, and facilities also help attract students (Sokoya, 2021; Toussaint et al., 2025). Parents, friends, and role models also play a big part in guiding and motivating students in their program choices (Aloamaka et al., 2020; Mickler Jr., 2021). In addition, age, gender, year level, and family income can affect a student's readiness and opportunity to continue studying (Enciso & De Sesto, 2025). These factors work together and show that both personal and school-related reasons influence student enrollment.

Studies also show that scholarships, financial aid, and the hope for a successful future are major reasons why students choose Business Administration programs. Financial help encourages students to study harder and makes college more affordable for everyone (Gabat-Lopez et al., 2024). Students also choose these programs because they believe business degrees can lead to better job opportunities and career growth (Caliat et al., 2023; Natividad et al., 2024). Location and accessibility of the school, as well as online visibility through marketing, also make a big difference in students' choices (Labausa et al., 2023; Triyono et al., 2021). Overall, these studies show that students' decisions to take Business Administration are shaped by school reputation, social influence, financial conditions, and career expectations, helping explain the enrollment patterns at a private higher education institution.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Social Cognitive Theory

The Social Cognitive Theory (SCT), developed by Bandura (1986), explains behavior as the result of a continuous interaction between personal beliefs, environmental factors, and behavioral patterns. SCT is particularly relevant to enrollment studies because students' decisions to pursue a program are shaped by observing and learning from their social environment, including parental influence, peer influence, and role model influence**,** which affect their self-efficacy and expectations for future success. Self-efficacy, defined as confidence in performing specific tasks, plays a critical role in academic decision-making and persistence (Bandura & Zumeri, 1997). Students who see supportive parents, high-achieving peers, or successful role models gain motivation, confidence, and assurance that they can succeed in the Business Administration program (Schunk & DiBenedetto, 2020). Therefore, SCT provides a useful framework for understanding how social learning and observational influences contribute to students' enrollment choices and their preparation for academic and career success.

Push-Pull Factor Theory

The Push–Pull Factor Theory by Lee (1966) explains that students make enrollment decisions based on pressures that push them away from less desirable options and attractions that pull them toward more favorable choices. Push factors include negative or limiting conditions such as poor job opportunities, financial restrictions, or dissatisfaction with other educational programs. Pull factors, meanwhile, consist of positive institutional attributes like academic reputation, career opportunities, scholarships, and a supportive learning environment. Prior research confirms that students react to both push and pull influences when choosing a school or program (Maringe & Gibbs, 2008; Wickneswary et al., 2024). At a private higher education institution, regional economic limitations and fewer higher-education options may act as push

factors for students. In contrast, institutional features function as strong pull factors, such as the presence of micro-credentials, which enhance employability by offering short, industry-aligned skills training, and industry partnership that provide internships, real-world exposure, and higher confidence in job placement . Additionally, the availability of specialization tracks that match students' interests, SHS strand, and career goals further draws them toward the BSBA program (Nguyen et al., 2023; European Commission, 2022). Together, these push and pull elements help explain how institutional offerings influence students' enrollment decisions.

The combination of these viewpoints makes the theoretical framework capture the psychological and contextual aspects of the enrollment choices. The Social Cognitive Theory is a theory that describes the process of developing beliefs, motivations, and aspirations that form a student's choice with the influence of parents, peers, and role models (Bandura & by Zumeri, 1997; Schunk & DiBenedetto, 2020). This is supplemented by the Push-Pull Factor Theory, which emphasizes the interactions of external conditions and institutional characteristics into the final choice, considering their disadvantages and opportunities (E. S. Lee, 1966; Wickneswary et al., 2024). These theories form a solid base for analyzing the quantitative relationship of personal, social, and environmental factors affecting the enrollment of business administration students.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

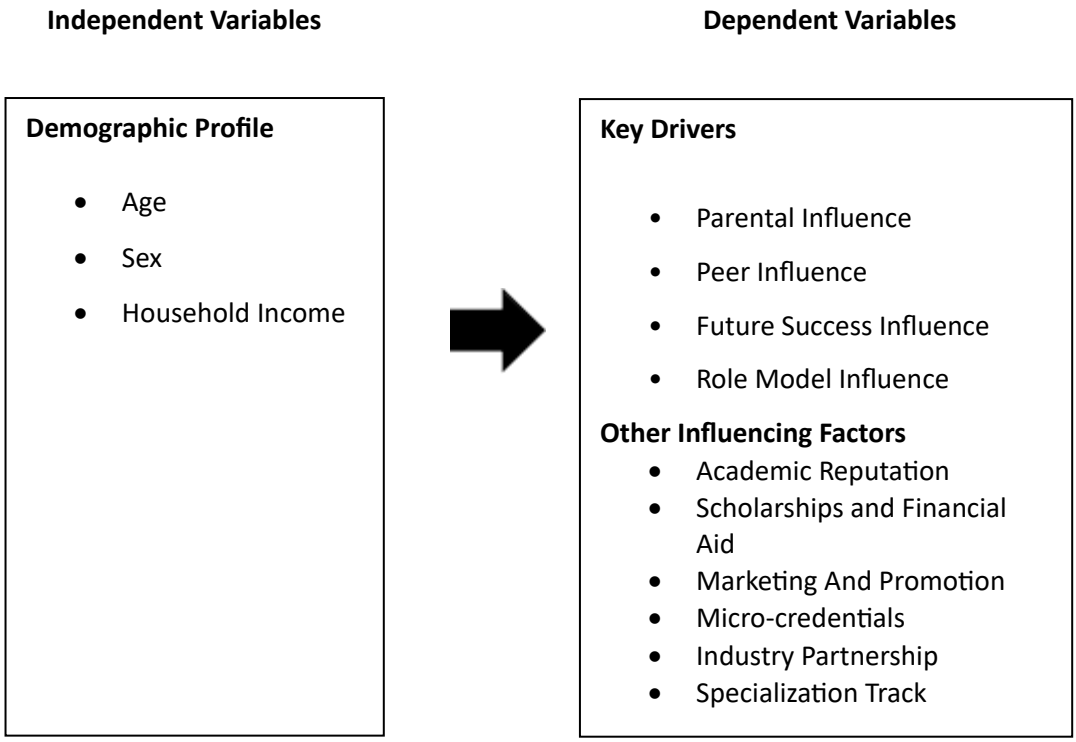


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the key drivers of enrollment in Business Administration Program at a selected private higher education institution in Caraga. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of:

    1.1 age;

    1.2 sex; and

    1.3 household income?

2. To what extent are key drivers of enrollment in the Business Administration Program in terms of:

    2.1 parental influence;

    2.2 peer influence;

    2.3 future success influence; and

    2.4 role model influence?

3. What are the other influencing factors of enrollment in the Business Administration Programs in terms of:

    3.1 academic reputation;

    3.2 scholarships and financial aid;

    3.3 marketing and promotion;

    3.4 micro-credentials;

    3.5 industry partnership; and

    3.6 specialization track?

4. Is there a significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers to other influencing factors of the students enrolled in business administration program?

5. Is there a significant relationship between identified drivers and other influencing factors of the students enrolled in business administration program?

1.6 Hypothesis

The hypothesis guided the study and tested at $\alpha = 0.05$ level of significance.

H_{01}: There is no significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers of the students enrolled in Business Administration program.

H_{02}: There is no significant relationship between identified drivers and other influencing factors affecting students' enrollment in Business Administration program.

H_{a1}: There is a significant relationship between demographic profile and identified drivers of the students enrolled in Business Administration program.

H_{a2}: There is a significant relationship between identified drivers and other influencing factors affecting students' enrollment in Business Administration program.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study focuses on identifying the key drivers that influence student enrollment in the Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program under the College of Business and Management (CBM) of a private higher education institution in Caraga**.** The study examines factors related to students' personal influences and other enrollment-related considerations that affect their decision to enroll in the BSBA program.

The scope of the study is limited to first-year to fourth-year BSBA students who are officially enrolled under the CBM during the period of data collection. Students from other academic programs within the institution, as well as students from other higher education institutions, are not included in the study. Primary data will be collected using an adapted and modified questionnaire designed to gather students' views on factors that influence their enrollment decisions.

As a limitation, the findings of this study are based only on the responses of BSBA students from the selected private higher education institution and reflect their personal perceptions. Therefore, the results may not be applied to other programs, institutions, or regions. In addition, since the study relies on self-reported survey data, some responses may be affected by personal bias or individual interpretation. Despite these limitations, the study provides useful information on the key drivers of enrollment within the context of a private higher education institution in Caraga.

1.8 Definition of Terms

For a better understanding and classification, the following terms and words are operationally defined as follows:

Academic Reputation – The perceived quality, credibility, and standing of the Business Administration program and the selected private higher education institution as perceived by the respondents.

Age – The number of years a respondent has lived since birth.

Future Success Influence – The respondent's perception that enrolling in the BSBA program enhances career opportunities, professional growth, and long-term success.

Household Income – The total combined income of all earning members of a respondent's household, used to assess the family's financial capacity to support education.

Industry Partnership – Collaborative arrangements between the BSBA program and external organizations that provide internships, training, mentorship, or employment opportunities for students.

Key Drivers of Enrollment – Factors that motivate or influence respondents to choose and enroll in the BSBA program.

Marketing and Promotion – Strategies and activities employed by the institution to attract prospective students, including advertising, social media engagement, outreach programs, and informational events.

Micro-credentials – A short, focused learning program or certification embedded within the BSBA curriculum that develops specific, industry-recognized skills or competencies.

Parental Influence – The effect of parents' guidance, expectations, support, or advice on a respondent's decision to enroll in the BSBA program.

Peer Influence – The impact of friends, classmates, or social networks on a respondent's enrollment decision.

Role Model Influence – The effect of admired individuals such as educators, professionals, or public figures on a respondent's choice of the BSBA program.

Scholarship and Financial Aid – Financial assistance, grants, or tuition support offered by the institution to reduce educational costs and encourage enrollment.

Sex – The biological or self-identified sex of the respondent, such as male or female.

Specialization Track – A focused area or concentration within the BSBA program (e.g., Marketing Management or Financial Management) that allows students to develop expertise in a specific field of business.

CHAPTER II

METHODOLOGY

This chapter will present the research design, locale, respondents, instrument, ethical standards, data-gathering procedures, data analysis plan and procedure that will be used in the study. It will also describe the materials and instruments to be employed and explain how the researchers will collect and analyze the data.

2.1 Research Design

The study will use a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design. The descriptive part will present the demographic profile of the respondents and the level of influence of the key drivers of enrollment. The correlational part will examine the relationship between the key drivers, including parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, and role model influence, and other influencing factors such as academic reputation, scholarships and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnership, and specialization track, and the students' decision to enroll in the Business Administration program. This design is appropriate because it allows the study to measure, describe, and analyze data using statistical tools at a 0.05 significance level.

2.2 Research Locale

The study was conducted at a selected private higher education institution located in the Caraga Region, Philippines. For ethical and confidentiality purposes, the name of the institution is not disclosed in this study. The institution offers a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) program with various specialization tracks under its College of Business and Management or its equivalent academic unit.

The selected institution was chosen due to its accessibility to the researchers and the availability of officially enrolled BSBA students who could provide relevant data regarding the

factors influencing their enrollment decisions. The Caraga Region serves as an appropriate setting for this study because it represents a developing educational context where private higher education institutions play a significant role in providing business education and workforce preparation.

By concealing the identity of the institution, the study ensures confidentiality while still allowing the findings to be analyzed and interpreted within a regional and institutional context.

2.3 Research Respondents

Table 1. *Respondents of the study*

Program	Year Level	Population	Frequency	Percentage
Financial Management	1st Year	63	36	20.45%
	2nd Year	40	22	12.50%
	3rd Year	48	27	15.34%
	4th year	50	28	15.91%
Marketing Management	1st Year	24	13	7.39%
	2nd Year	21	12	6.82%
	4th Year	16	9	5.11%
Human Resource Management	1st Year	14	8	4.55%
	3rd Year	9	5	2.84%
	4th Year	13	7	3.98%
Operations Management	1st Year	16	9	5.11%
TOTAL		**314**	**176**	**100%**

The respondents of the study consist of 176 BSBA students selected from a total population of 314 students enrolled in the College of Business and Management of a selected private higher education institution for Academic Year 2025–2026.

To ensure proportional representation across programs and year levels, the researchers employed a stratified random sampling technique**,** wherein students were grouped according to their major and year level before randomly selecting respondents from each stratum. This method ensures that all programs and year levels from 1st to 4th year are adequately represented in the sample.

Data were gathered using a structured survey questionnaire designed to measure key enrollment drivers, including parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, and role model influence, as well as other factors such as academic reputation, scholarships and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnerships, and specialization tracks.

2.4 Research Instrument

The primary research instrument used in this study is a researcher-developed structured survey questionnaire designed to address the objectives of the study and to measure the key drivers influencing student enrollment in the BSBA program of the selected private higher education institution. The questionnaire consists of items tailored to the institutional context and the variables under investigation, as guided by the theoretical framework and related literature.

To ensure the quality of the instrument, both validity and reliability procedures will be conducted. Content validity will be established through evaluation by a panel of subject-matter experts who will assess the relevance, clarity, and appropriateness of the questionnaire items. Pilot testing was conducted among fifteen (15) randomly selected college students from a selected private higher education institution in Caraga who were not included in the actual study sample. The purpose of the pilot test was to assess the clarity, reliability, and appropriateness of the questionnaire items. Feedback gathered from the pilot testing was used to refine the instrument, improve item wording, and ensure its suitability prior to the actual data collection.

The questionnaire will be divided into two parts:

- **Part I:** presents the demographic profile of the respondents, including age, sex, and household income; and
- **Part II:** consists of items measuring the degree of influence. parental, peer, role model, and future success drivers, as well as other variables such as academic reputation, scholarship and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnership, and specialization track.

A. Key Drivers of Enrollment in Business Administration Program.

B. Other Influencing Factors of Business Administration Program.

The researcher will use descriptive statistics to analyze the data gathered, and the mean will be used as primary statistical tool. In this study, the researcher will summarize and describe the key drivers influencing student enrollment in the Business Administration program.

The statement will be interpreted using the Likert scale. It will use a 4-point rating scale, where a score of 4 “Strongly Agree” will correspond to a mean range of 3.25 to 4.00, indicating a high level of agreement. A score of 3 “Agree” will fall between 2.50 and 3.24, reflecting moderate agreement. A score of 2 “Disagree” will correspond to a mean range of 1.75 to 2.49, suggesting low agreement. Lastly, a score of 1 “Strongly Disagree” will be associated with a mean range of 1.00 to 1.74, signifying a very low level of agreement. This scale will be used to evaluate the strength of respondents’ perceptions regarding the key factors influencing their enrollment decisions.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Protection

In this study, no new products, technologies, or symbols of any kind needed to be patented or trademarked. Each secondary source will be properly referenced, and copyrighted works will be

utilized only as an academic requirement. The intellectual property rights will be safeguard by ensuring originality and due credit to third-party content.

B. Informed Consent

The study's objectives, procedures, and benefits will be presented to the respondents as an information sheet. Before answering the questionnaire, written consent will be obtained to ascertain the respondents' voluntary nature in answering the survey. In the case of individuals who will be below 18 years of age, their parents or guardians will be contacted. The consent form will be composed in simple and straightforward language to ensure complete understanding

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

To ensure confidentiality, the answers will be coded and depersonalized. The data will be safely stored, and only the researcher accessed them. The reported results will be presented in aggregate form; thus, it will be impossible to trace individual responses from the participants.

D. Voluntary Participation

The study will be conducted on a completely voluntary basis. Respondents will be informed that they have the right to withdraw at any point without penalty. This will guarantee their freedom and will provide a dignified atmosphere to every participant.

E. Minimization of Harm

The study will not subject the participants to physical, emotional, or psychological injury. The questions in the survey will be carefully designed to avoid sensitive or offensive content. Participants will be provided with access to support mechanisms, such as school counseling services, in case any discomfort will arise.

F. Beneficence

Even though direct benefits might not be given to the participants, their responses will provide valuable insights into the factors that drive students to pursue Business Administration. These findings will be used to improve institutional policies and practices at private higher education institution. A summary of the results will be made available to respondents upon request.

G. Justice and Equitable Participant Recruitment

The respondents will be selected according to clear inclusion criteria that will encompass all first year to fourth year students of Business Administration. They will be chosen without prejudice based on gender, age, and socioeconomic status to promote fairness and representation.

H. Data Accuracy and Data Integrity

Data collection and analysis will be conducted objectively using standardized tools and procedures. The questionnaire will be tested for reliability, and the results will be reviewed for consistency. It will be ensured that there will be no data manipulation or falsification.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The authors of the study will describe the research results accurately without distorting the data. The limitations will be acknowledged, and all the sources of information will be properly cited. The research process and results will not be influenced by any conflict of interest.

J. Copyrighted Materials

All copyrighted academic materials and references will be properly cited. The conduct of the study will not violate copyright laws or academic ethics, as full credit will be given to the original authors.

K. Human Subjects Considerations

The security and dignity of the human respondents will be prioritized. Informed consent, voluntary involvement, and confidentiality will be strictly observed in accordance with institutional and international ethical standards for research involving human subjects.

L. Conscientious AI and Digital Usage

The researcher will be assisted by digital tools such as ChatGPT for idea generation and writing guidance, Grammarly for grammar and clarity enhancement, and QuillBot for rewording and refinement. The application of these tools will be responsibly, and all outputs will be critically evaluated to ensure accuracy, originality, and ethical compliance. The only assistance to be utilized from AI tools will serve as writing aids and will not replace human judgement.

M. Ethical Approval

The Saint Michael College of Caraga Institutional Review Board will grant ethical approval, ensuring compliance with the highest standards for respondents' safety, data confidentiality, and intellectual property.

N. Disposal

After the completion of the study, all research data will be securely disposed of through shredding of hard copies and permanent deletion of electronic files in accordance with institutional ethical guidelines.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

This section describes the steps followed by the researchers in collecting, organizing, and analyzing the data needed for the study.

Permission to Obtain Enrollment Data. The researchers request permission from the School Registrar's Office to obtain the total number of Business Administration students enrolled at a selected private higher education institution as of October 2025.

Letter of Approval. The researchers submit a letter of request to the dean for review and approval of the survey questionnaire, including the process of validity testing and pilot testing.

Survey Questionnaire. The researchers use a researcher-developed structured survey questionnaire aligned with the objectives of the study.

Informed Consent. Before conducting the study, the researchers inform the respondents about the research procedure and obtain their consent to participate in the study.

Consolidation of Data. The researchers gather, check, assess, tally, present, and interpret the collected data using appropriate statistical tools in consultation with the research statistician.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

The data gathered from the survey questionnaires will undergo a systematic and rigorous process of analysis. All accomplished questionnaires will first be retrieved, reviewed for completeness, and properly organized. The responses will then be encoded, classified, and tabulated to ensure accuracy, consistency, and reliability of the data. After the data have been cleaned and organized, appropriate statistical tools will be employed to analyze the respondents' demographic profile, determine the level of influence of the key drivers of enrollment, and examine the relationship between these drivers and students' enrollment decisions in the Business Administration programs.

Statistical Treatment

The following statistical tools will be used in the analysis of the data:

Frequency and Percentage. These will describe the demographic profile of respondents in terms of age, sex, and household income.

Weighted Mean. This will measure the level of influence of key drivers, including parental influence, peer influence, future success influence, and role model influence, as well as other influencing factors such as academic reputation, scholarships and financial aid, marketing and promotion, micro-credentials, industry partnership, and specialization track on enrollment decisions.

Pearson Product – Moment Correlation. This will be used to determine the significant relationship between:

1. Respondents' demographic profile and the identified key drivers of enrollment.
2. The key drivers and other influencing factors affecting students' enrollment in the Business Administration program.

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Research Questionnaire

Name (Optional): _____

Address (Optional): _____

Part 1: Respondent's Profile

Instructions:

Please answer this questionnaire properly and sincerely by putting a check mark (/) in the space that best corresponds to your observation on the following items using the following criteria:

Age

☐ 18-20 Years Old

☐ 21-23 Years Old

☐ 24 Years Old and Above

Sex

☐ Male

☐ Female

Household Income Per Month

☐ Below- P10,000

☐ P10,001- P20,000

☐ P20,001- P30,000

☐ P30,000 - Above

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Part II: A Study on the Drivers of Students' Choice in Enrolling in the Business Administration Programs.

General Instructions:

Please check the statement using the scale provided that best describes how much each factor influenced your decision to enroll in the **Business Administration programs** of a selected **Private Higher Education** in Caraga. We encourage you to answer honestly, as the accuracy of this study depends on your responses.

Rating Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
4	Strongly Agree (SA)	The statement is highly influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
3	Agree (A)	The statement moderately influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
2	Disagree (D)	The statement slightly influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.
1	Strongly Disagree (SD)	The statement did not influenced my decision to enroll in BSBA.

A. Key Drivers of Enrollment in Business Administration Program

a. Parental Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. My parents encouraged me to take the BSBA program.				
2. My parents believe Business Administration offers good career opportunities				
3. My parents' educational background influenced my course decision.				
4. My parents' approval was important in choosing my program.				
5. My parents helped me select a program aligned with my strengths and interests.				

b. Peers Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. My friends encouraged me to enroll in the BSBA program.				
2. I was influenced by classmates who also chose Business Administration.				
3. I tend to choose programs recommended by my closest peers.				
4. Seeing my peers succeed academically motivated me to choose this program.				
5. My peer group helped shape my perception of the BSBA program.				

c. Future Success Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. The BSBA program provides many employment opportunities after graduation.				
2. I believe the BSBA degree will help me achieve my long-term career goals.				
3. The skills taught in this program are valuable in the job market.				
4. I chose BSBA because it is aligned with my desired profession.				
5. I believe that pursuing BSBA will help me gain financial stability in the future.				

d. Role Model Influence	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. I was influenced by a person I admire who is successful in the field of business.				

2. My teachers and mentors encouraged me to consider the BSBA program.				
3. Seeing professionals in business careers inspired me to take BSBA.				
4. I follow business-related influencers or personalities whose careers I want to emulate.				
5. My role models made me feel confident about taking a business-related course.				

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B. Other Influencing Factors of Business Administration Program

a. Academic Reputation	SA (4)	A (3)	D (2)	SD (1)
1. SMCC has a good reputation in offering business programs.				
2. The BSBA program is known for having competent instructors.				
3. The program is recognized by students for its quality curriculum.				
4. The reputation of SMCC influenced my decision to enroll.				
b. Scholarship and Financial Aid				
1. The availability of scholarships influenced my decision to study at SMCC.				
2. Financial aid programs make the BSBA program more accessible.				
3. I enrolled because the program is financially manageable for my family.				
4. Discounts or grants offered by the school encouraged me to continue BSBA.				
c. Marketing and Promotion				

1. Social media postings about SMCC influenced my decision to enroll.				
2. Advertisements or online promotion helped me learn about the program.				
3. The school's promotional strategies increased my interest in the BSBA program.				
4. Radio advertisements about SMCC influenced my decision to enroll in the BSBA program.				
d. Micro-credentials				
1. Micro-credential programs offered by SMCC attracted me to the BSBA program.				
2. Certifications such as CFMPA, CMMS, CHRA, and others influenced my decision.				
3. I believe micro-credentials can improve my employability.				
4. I value the extra training and skill development the program provides.				
e. Industry Partnership				
1. Strong partnerships with companies influenced my choice of program.				
2. Internship opportunities offered by SMCC motivated me to take BSBA.				
3. I believe industry collaborations improve practical learning.				
4. The possibility of employment linkages encouraged me to enroll.				
f. Specialization Track				
1. The availability of different BSBA majors influenced my decision.				
2. I chose to enroll because I am interested in the specialization offered.				
3. The specialization I chose matches my career goals.				
4. The specialization tracks in BSBA made the program more appealing.				

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Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
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Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Member**

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Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC College of Business and Management - Local Student Government	**Marketing Management Representative**
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Marketing Management - 3 Mayor**

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Weight	:	54
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Elementary	:	Gosoon Elementary School
Secondary	:	Vinapor National High School
Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Member**

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Educational Attainment

Elementary	:	Consuelo Elementary School
Secondary	:	Holy Trinity College
Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC Junior Organization of Business Speculator	**Public Information Officer**